AGENT DEFAULTS

Forks are the default now. My rule isn't.

Claude Code 2.1.302 turned fork subagents on by default in claude -p, the Agent SDK, the desktop app and VS Code. A second agent still has to earn its cost.

UNROLL THE DRAWING

SECTION 02 · DOCS MECHANICS

A fork inherits the chat. A subagent starts cold.

Per the docs, a non-fork subagent gets a fresh, isolated context and never sees the conversation history. A fork inherits the parent conversation. Each subagent spends tokens of its own.

FIG. 2

NON-FORK	VS	FORK
— STARTS COLD		• INHERITS THE CHAT
— ISOLATED CONTEXT		• NOT A FRESH START

SCALE · PRODUCTION

VERYDIAN

SECTION 03 · MY PIPELINE

Three stage agents, each starting cold

Researcher, writer, editor. Each gets its own brief and the week string, and reads the previous stage's file. None inherits another's reasoning.

FIG. 3



SECTION 04 · STANDING RULE

My policy: four rules before any spawn

Single agent is the default. A second one has to earn its cost in tokens saved or quality gained.

FIG. 4

01

FAN-OUT RESEARCH

02

PARALLEL, NO OVERLAP

03

NEVER ROUTINE WORK

04

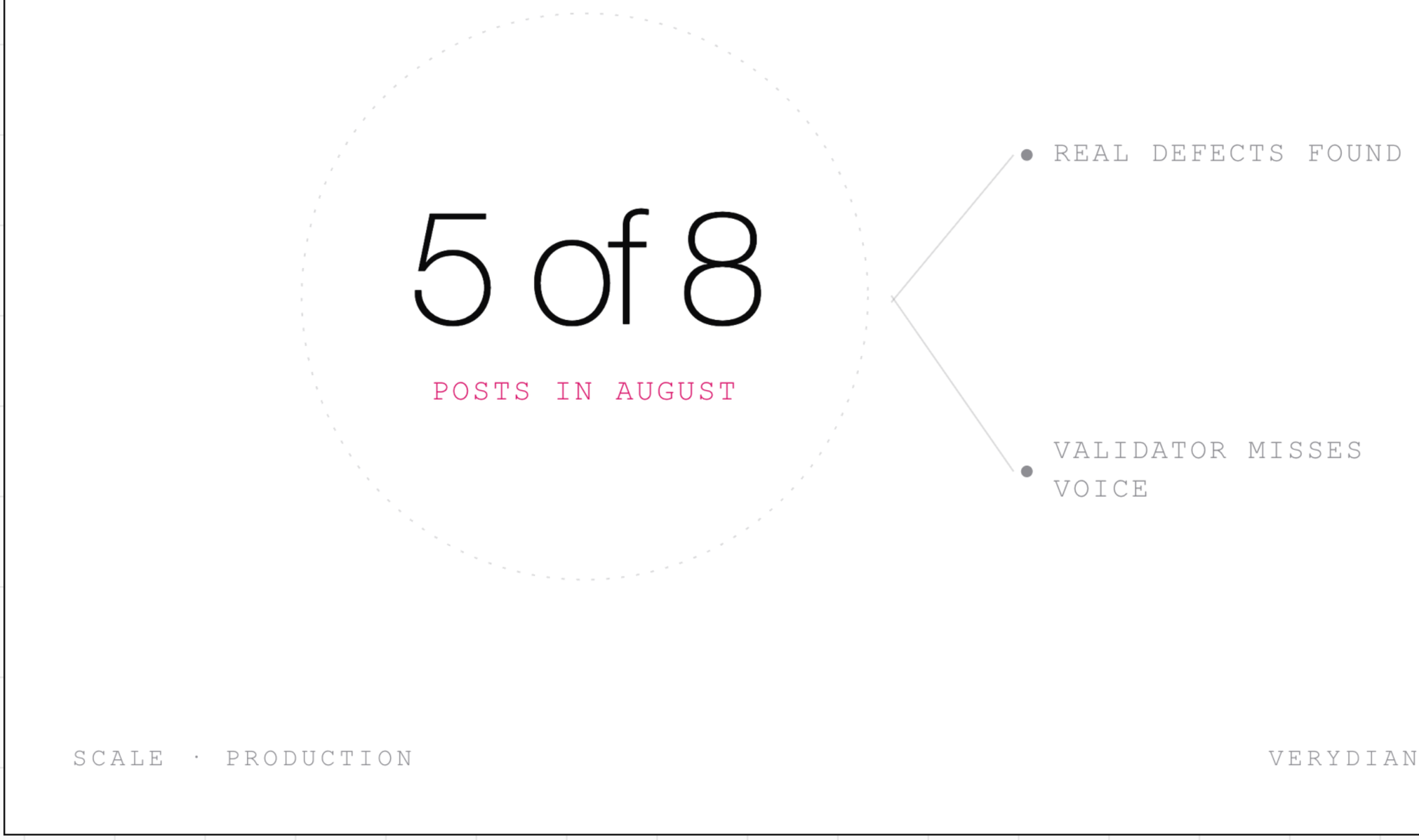
RE-PAYS CONTEXT

SECTION 05 · EDITOR EVIDENCE

The editor found defects in 5 of 8 posts

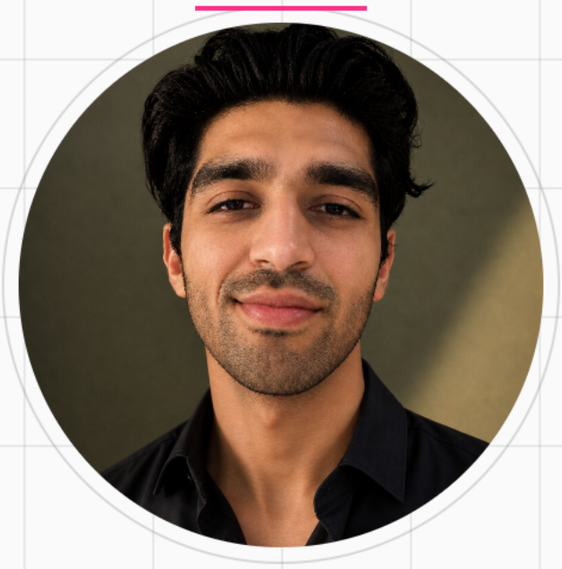
One August run. One was a caption with no first-person voice, which the validator can't catch. My handoff note: the editor stage is not a formality.

FIG. 5



SCALE · PRODUCTION

VERYDIAN



Every spawn gets one question first

What does this second agent buy that the first one can't?

TEST EVERY SPAWN